

## Second Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Secunda Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: charity embodied in the banquet of God

| Proper    | TLM text / reference                                    | Scriptural axis                                   | Fathers and saints                                                    | Connection                                                                                                 |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introit   | <i>Factus est Dominus protector meus</i> (Ps. 17)       | Rescue into breadth                               | St. Ambrose on the Psalms; Cassiodorus on Psalm 17                    | The Lord does not merely defend; he brings the soul into the wide place of divine charity.                 |
| Collect   | Fear and love of the holy Name                          | Holy fear and stable love                         | St. Bernard on the Name of Jesus; St. Catherine of Siena on holy fear | The prayer joins reverence and intimacy: fear keeps love from presumption, love keeps fear from servility. |
| Epistle   | 1 John 3:13-18                                          | Passing from death to life by loving the brethren | St. Augustine, Homilies on 1 John; St. John Chrysostom on almsgiving  | Charity must leave the tongue and enter work and truth.                                                    |
| Gospel    | Luke 14:16-24                                           | The great supper                                  | St. Gregory the Great, Gospel homilies; St. Bede on Luke              | Excuses reveal disordered loves; the poor and broken reveal the gratuitous wideness of the invitation.     |
| Offertory | <i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam</i> (Ps. 6) | Conversion before communion                       | Desert Fathers on compunction                                         | The banquet is entered by being turned around, not by self-justification.                                  |
| Communion | <i>Cantabo Domino, qui bona tribuit mihi</i> (Ps. 12)   | Thanksgiving for benefits                         | St. Ignatius of Loyola, gratitude as root of service                  | The communicant sings because the supper is already gift before it is task.                                |

### Homily Sketch

**Proposition.** The great supper is charity offered before it is charity commanded. The soul that has been invited into God’s abundance must stop treating mercy as an interruption.

**Opening movement.** The Introit begins with deliverance into breadth: *eduxit me in latitudinem*. The Gospel shows that breadth as a banquet large enough for the poor, weak, blind, and lame. The narrowness is not in God but in our excuses.

**Doctrinal center.** The Collect asks for fear and love together. Holy fear hears the summons; love rises and comes. Without fear, invitation becomes cheap; without love, fear never reaches the table.

**Moral turn.** The Epistle refuses sentimental religion: “not in word, nor in tongue; but in deed, and in truth.” The invited man becomes an inviting man, especially toward the brother in need.

## Exegetical Notes

- Luke 14 is spoken at table. Christ turns an ordinary meal into an image of the Kingdom and of Eucharistic readiness.
- The excuses are not gross sins. Land, oxen, and marriage are legitimate goods made ultimate.
- The servant's mission widens in stages: invited guests, city streets, then roads and hedges. Grace presses outward.

| Witness               | Short text                                                     | Homiletic use                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| St. Augustine         | "Love, and do what thou wilt." Homily on 1 John                | Explain carefully: Augustine means rightly ordered charity fulfills action, not that impulse replaces obedience. |
| St. Gregory the Great | The poor brought to supper show those whom the proud overlook. | Use Gregory to expose respectable refusals and to honor the hidden guests of God.                                |
| St. John Chrysostom   | Almsgiving is a concrete test of love for Christ.              | Tie the Epistle's "deed and truth" to parish works of mercy.                                                     |
| St. Benedict          | Prefer nothing to the love of Christ.                          | The good things named in the excuses must remain below the supreme good.                                         |

| Thread                         | Synthesis                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Banquet and almsgiving</b>  | The Epistle tests the Gospel. One cannot accept the invitation to the great supper while closing the heart to a needy brother.           |
| <b>Excuses and attachments</b> | Field, oxen, and marriage are goods; they become refusals when treated as ultimate. This is a classic patristic reading of ordered love. |
| <b>Fear and love</b>           | The Collect prevents two errors: servile terror that avoids the table, and casual presumption that ignores the summons.                  |
| <b>Church and mission</b>      | The servant who announces supper is an image of apostolic preaching: the Church compels by truth, beauty, mercy, and urgency.            |
| <b>Prayer focus</b>            | Identify the respectable excuse that keeps charity theoretical, then answer the invitation through one concrete act of mercy.            |

## Four Senses of Scripture

| Thread             | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Literal</b>     | Luke 14 presents a man making a great supper, the invited guests refusing through excuses, and the poor and wounded being brought in.                             |
| <b>Allegorical</b> | The supper signifies the Kingdom and the Eucharistic banquet of the Church, where Israel's call opens into the gathering of the nations and the spiritually poor. |
| <b>Moral</b>       | The hearer must examine respectable attachments that make him refuse grace, then prove charity in deed and truth as 1 John commands.                              |
| <b>Anagogical</b>  | The earthly invitation anticipates the eternal wedding feast, where every excuse will be exposed and every healed poverty will become joy.                        |

## Preaching Applications

- Name modern excuses without contempt: busyness, family logistics, work, property, reputation, and curated comfort.
- Press the Eucharistic question: do I come to the Lord's table while refusing the brother Christ has seated near me?
- Offer one concrete practice: before Sunday Mass, choose one act of hidden charity for someone who cannot repay it.

## Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Secunda post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Augustine on 1 John; Gregory the Great on Luke 14; Bede on the Gospel of Luke.